

DAY 2

Project Understanding & Stakeholder Communication

Learning Objectives:

- Learn how to read and understand a project brief or business requirement
- Understand who stakeholders are and how to identify them on any project
- Learn the stakeholder matrix: Power vs Interest grid
- Understand communication planning: who needs what information, how often, and in what format
- **YouTube Search Terms:**
 - "How to understand a project brief"
 - "Stakeholder analysis for beginners"
 - "Stakeholder communication plan template"
 - "Power interest grid explained"
- **Recommended Channels:**
 - Google Project Management Certificate
 - PM Majik
 - [ProjectManager.com](https://www.projectmanager.com)

Tasks:

- Study the stakeholder identification process — learn how to identify internal vs external stakeholders and why their influence level matters for every decision you make
- Learn the Power-Interest matrix — understand how it shapes your communication frequency and depth with each stakeholder group
- Read about communication plans — what they contain, why PMs create them before the project starts, and what happens when no plan exists
- Draft a stakeholder register for a hypothetical app launch project — include at least 6 stakeholders with their role, influence level, communication preference, and what information they need
- Write a communication plan for the same project covering who gets updates, how often, through which channel, and what format

Deliverable

- Stakeholder register for the hypothetical project
- Communication plan document
- Short note: what happens when stakeholder communication breaks down — one real-world example

What is a Project Brief

A project brief is that essential document which defines the client's primary requirements for the project. It contains important details and features for that said project. A good project brief is well detailed and explanatory. However, there are some project briefs which aren't straight to the point, they are called project briefs still but, a complicated and complex one.

It generally includes :

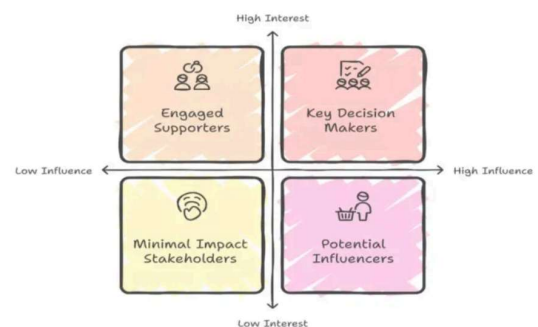
1. What are the major deliverables?
2. How will we get to those deliverables and the deadline?
3. Who is on the project team and what role will they play in those deliverables?
4. When will the team meet milestones, and when will other members of the team play a role in contributing to or providing feedback on those deliverables?

Stakeholder Analysis

A stakeholder analysis is a process of identifying these people before the project begins; grouping them according to their levels of participation, interest, and influence in the project; and determining how best to involve and communicate each of these stakeholder groups throughout. In this video, we'll cover the importance of stakeholder analysis and teach you how to conduct an efficient stakeholder analysis with a power/interest grid.



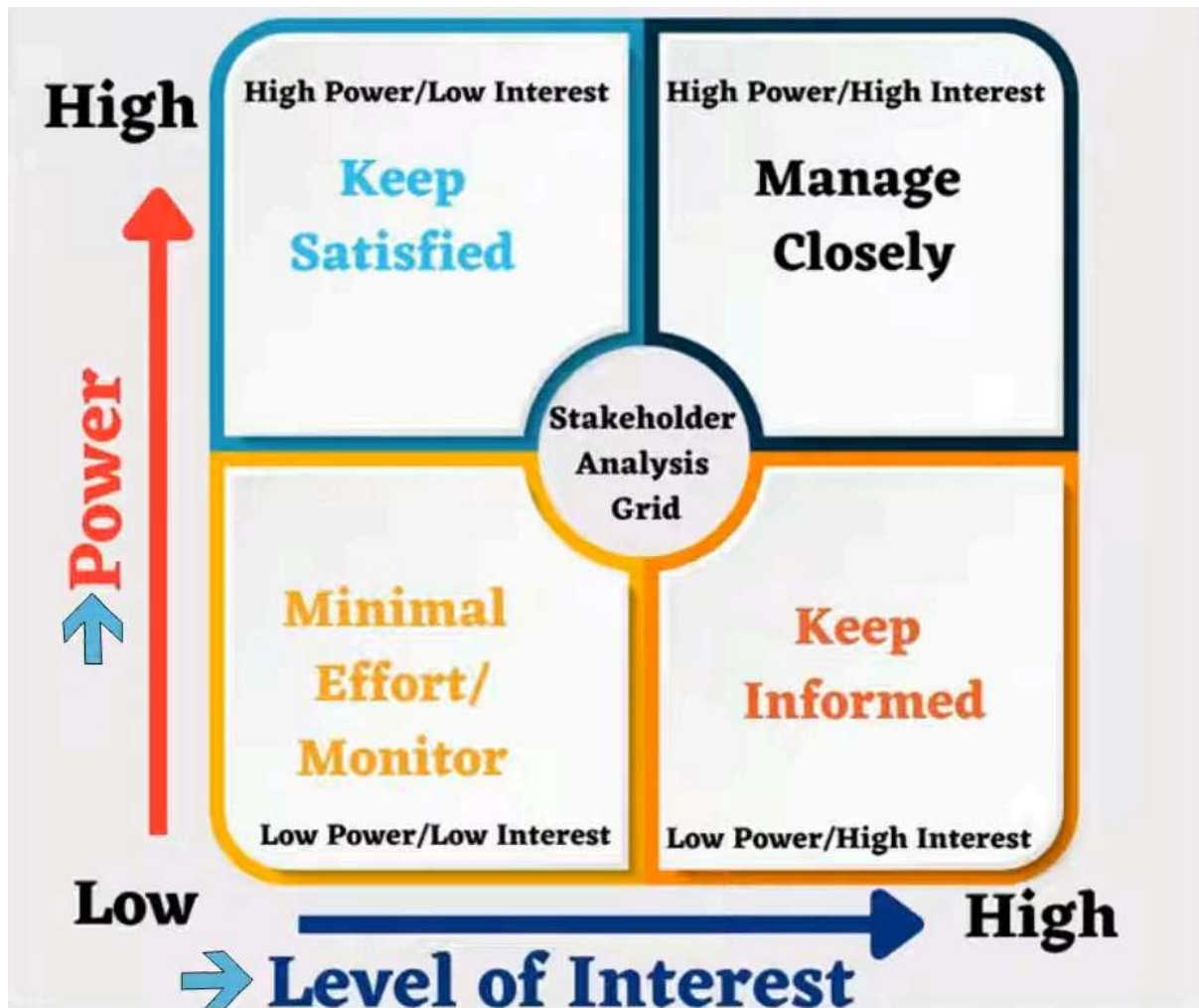
Stakeholder Analysis Matrix



Project stakeholders are commonly categorized into **four types** based on their **level of power and interest**:

- **High Power, High Interest:** These are key players who require close collaboration and regular engagement, such as project sponsors and senior executives.
- **High Power, Low Interest:** These are influential stakeholders who must be kept satisfied with periodic updates, such as regulatory bodies or high-level decision-makers who do not need daily details.

- **Low Power, High Interest:** These are engaged supporters who should be kept informed and have their concerns addressed, such as end-users or community members who are affected by the outcome but lack authority over the project.
- **Low Power, Low Interest:** These are secondary stakeholders who require only periodic monitoring, such as media outlets or advocacy groups that have minimal direct impact on the project's execution.



Stakeholder Register for a Hypothetical App Launch Project

Project: SmartTask - A Task Management Mobile App

Stakeholder	Role	Influence Level	Communication Preference	Information Needed
Project Sponsor	Provides funding and approvals	High	Email & Meetings	Budget status, project progress, risks
Project Manager	Leads and coordinates project	High	Daily Meetings	Complete project updates
Development Team	Builds the application	High	Slack/Teams & Stand-ups	Requirements, tasks, deadlines
UI/UX Designer	Designs app interface	Medium	Meetings & Design Tools	User requirements, feedback
Marketing Team	Promotes the app launch	Medium	Email & Weekly Meetings	Launch schedule, product features
End Users	Use the final application	Medium	Surveys & Feedback Forms	App features, updates, support information
Quality Assurance Team	Tests the application	High	Bug Tracking Tools & Meetings	Requirements, defects, testing schedule
App Store/Play Store Review Team	Approves app publication	Low	Submission Portal	App compliance and documentation

Stakeholder Communication Plan Template

Project Name		Project Start Date						
Project Manager		Project End Date						
Client Name		Project Duration	0					
Project Overview								
Stakeholder Communication Plan								
Method Of Communication	Description/ Purpose of Communication	Communication Frequency	Audience/ Stakeholders	Owner	Format	Commucation Start Date	Additional Comments	

Communication Plan

Stakeholder	Information Shared	Frequency	Channel	Format
Project Sponsor	Progress, budget, risks	Weekly	Email/Meeting	Status Report
Project Manager	Project activities	Daily	Stand-up Meeting	Verbal Update
Development Team	Tasks and requirements	Daily	Teams/Slack	Task Board
QA Team	Testing progress and bugs	Daily	Jira/Meeting	Bug Reports
UI/UX Designer	Design feedback	Weekly	Meeting	Design Review
Marketing Team	Feature updates and launch plan	Weekly	Email	Summary Report
End Users	New features and launch updates	Monthly	Newsletter/App Notification	Announcement
App Store Review Team	App submission documents	As Needed	Submission Portal	Compliance Documents

Short Note: What Happens When Stakeholder Communication Breaks Down?

Stakeholder communication is one of the most important responsibilities of a Project Manager. When communication breaks down, stakeholders may receive incomplete or incorrect information, leading to misunderstandings, missed deadlines, budget overruns, and reduced project quality. Team members may work on the wrong requirements, and decision-makers may not be aware of critical risks.

Real-World Example: Healthcare.gov Website Launch (2013)

The launch of the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services Healthcare.gov website faced major issues due to poor communication among government agencies, contractors, and project stakeholders. Different teams were not fully aligned on requirements, testing was insufficient, and critical issues were not communicated effectively before launch. As a result, the website experienced significant technical failures when it went live, affecting millions of users and requiring extensive rework.

Key Lesson

Effective stakeholder communication ensures that:

- Everyone understands project goals.
- Risks are identified early.
- Decisions are made quickly.
- Expectations remain aligned.
- Projects are delivered successfully and on time.